S A D H A N A

Tracking chants with intention

A Japa companion that counts quietly, keeps every Sankalp apart, and makes the practice easy to look back on.

CONCEPT METER

FACULTY Chakradhar Saswade

BY Poorvesh Dali



It is 6:40 in the morning. You are deep into a round of Gayatri, somewhere past the eightieth bead.

The phone rings.

When you come back, which bead were you on?

Sadhana is built around this moment: the count that survives an interruption, and the practice you can look back on afterwards.



Where tracking becomes difficult

A practitioner with several intentions struggles to keep each one’s practice clear.

1
Recalling rounds

Completed rounds are hard to remember across sittings.

A day can hold several sittings. Without a record, the running total depends on memory.

2
Separate intentions

Several Sankalps each need their own record.

Gayatri and Shiva counts need their own goals and history, not one mixed total.

3
Interruptions

After a break, resuming with confidence is difficult.

A call or a pause can break a round. It is unclear where to begin again.

4
Logging afterwards

Manual notes break attention, or are forgotten.

Stopping to write pulls attention away. Later notes are partial, or never made.

Also: a physical mala gives tactile counting, but it gives no lasting practice history.

Pain points in three everyday scenarios

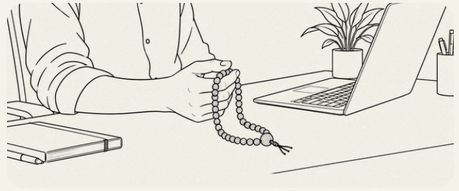
Several Sankalps, one mala

SCENARIO 1



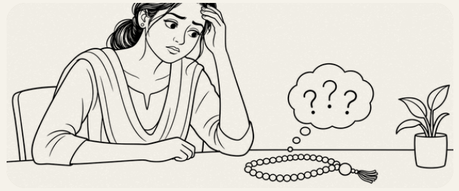
Morning: a few rounds of Gayatri on the mala.

Pain: Rounds not recorded



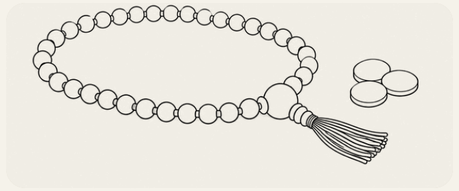
Midday: a short Shiva Japa at the desk.

Pain: Separate intention, same mala



Evening: unsure how many rounds each one took.

Pain: Relies on memory



Totals are guessed and mixed across mantras.

Pain: No separate record per Sankalp

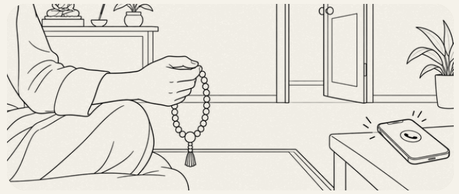
Interrupted mid-round

SCENARIO 2



Mid-round, bead by bead, deep in focus.

Pain: Count held only in the head



A call or a knock breaks the round.

Pain: Attention broken



Unsure which bead was the last count.

Pain: Place in the round lost

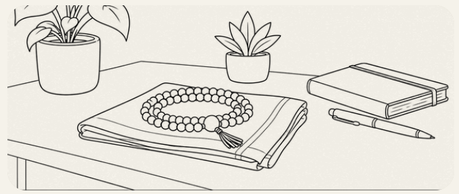


Restarts the round, or guesses the count.

Pain: Confidence in the count lost

Noting it down breaks focus

SCENARIO 3



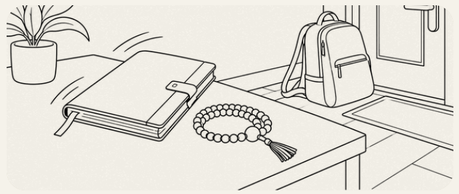
Finishes a sitting with a diary nearby.

Pain: Needs a separate tool



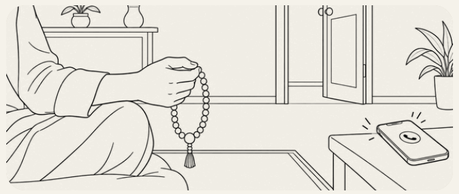
Stops to note the rounds; attention drifts.

Pain: Focus pulled away



On a rushed day, the note is skipped.

Pain: The record gets forgotten



Weeks later, no clear history of the practice.

Pain: No lasting history

Who we are designing for

Regular practitioners who keep more than one mantra or Sankalp.

BEHAVIOURS

- Chants regularly, in sittings through the week
- Holds several mantras or intentions at once
- Wants each intention’s record kept apart
- May be interrupted mid-round

GOALS

- A focused chanting experience
- Separate records per Sankalp
- Reliable continuation after a break
- A history that is easy to understand



A behaviour-based profile from the brief. The collective persona on the next slide is an assumption to validate.

The regular practitioner

A composite built from the project brief, not interviews. Details are assumptions to validate.



WHO THEY ARE

A spiritual, married office-goer who makes time to chant around the working day, and needs a tracker for it.

- Chants regularly
- Married
- Office job, travels daily
- 108-bead mala and a smartphone

GOAL

Keep every Sankalp clear and understand the practice over time, without leaving the familiar rhythm of the mala.

NEEDS

- A tracker for chanting
- Separate record per Sankalp
- Resume after an interruption
- A history that is easy to read

FRUSTRATIONS

- Losing count after a break
- Mixed totals across mantras
- Notes that pull attention away
- A mala that keeps no history

From a possible problem to a design opportunity

PROBLEM

Counts, rounds and sittings are hard to keep clear across several Sankalps.

USER NEED

Count without losing focus, and recall practice later.

OPPORTUNITY

Track the familiar counting action and organise records by intention.

HOW MIGHT WE

track familiar counting actions and make practice understandable afterward?

What the solution must achieve

Each requirement is linked to a way of evaluating it.

REQUIREMENT	HOW WE WOULD EVALUATE IT
Familiar handling	Does it feel natural on a mala people already own?
Reliable counts	Missed and false counts against manual observation
Minimal attention	Can attention stay on the mantra, not the device?
Multiple Sankalps	Do records stay separate and easy to read?
Good fit	Comfort, grip and retention across different malas
Interruption recovery	Can a session resume with the correct count?

TONE calm feedback only. No streaks, points or performance pressure.

Five ways to capture the same action

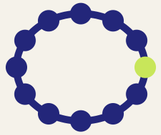
One chant per bead advance. Which object should do the counting?



Phone counter

Hold the screen or press volume buttons

EARLIER



Smart ring

A bead ring senses each advance

EARLIER



Integrated mala

Sensors built into the beads

NEW IDEA



Guru-bead attachment

A module on the mala senses advances

EARLIER



Round counter

One press per completed round

NEW IDEA

Comparing the options

The attachment keeps the practitioner's own mala, but carries the highest sensing risk.

OPTION	FAMILIAR HANDLING	DISTRACTION	FIT WITH OWN MALA	RELIABILITY RISK	COMPLEXITY
Phone counter	Medium	Higher: needs screen	Not applicable	Low: deliberate input	Low
Smart ring	Medium: new object	Low	Needs sizing	Medium	High
Integrated mala	High	Low	Replaces own mala	Medium	High
Guru-bead attachment	High: keeps own mala	Low	Must suit many malas	High: sensing unproven	Medium to high
Round counter	Medium	Low to medium	Easy	Medium: relies on memory	Low

Qualitative and provisional design assessment, not test results. Green is favourable, amber is mixed, coral is a concern. The round counter records rounds, not individual chants.

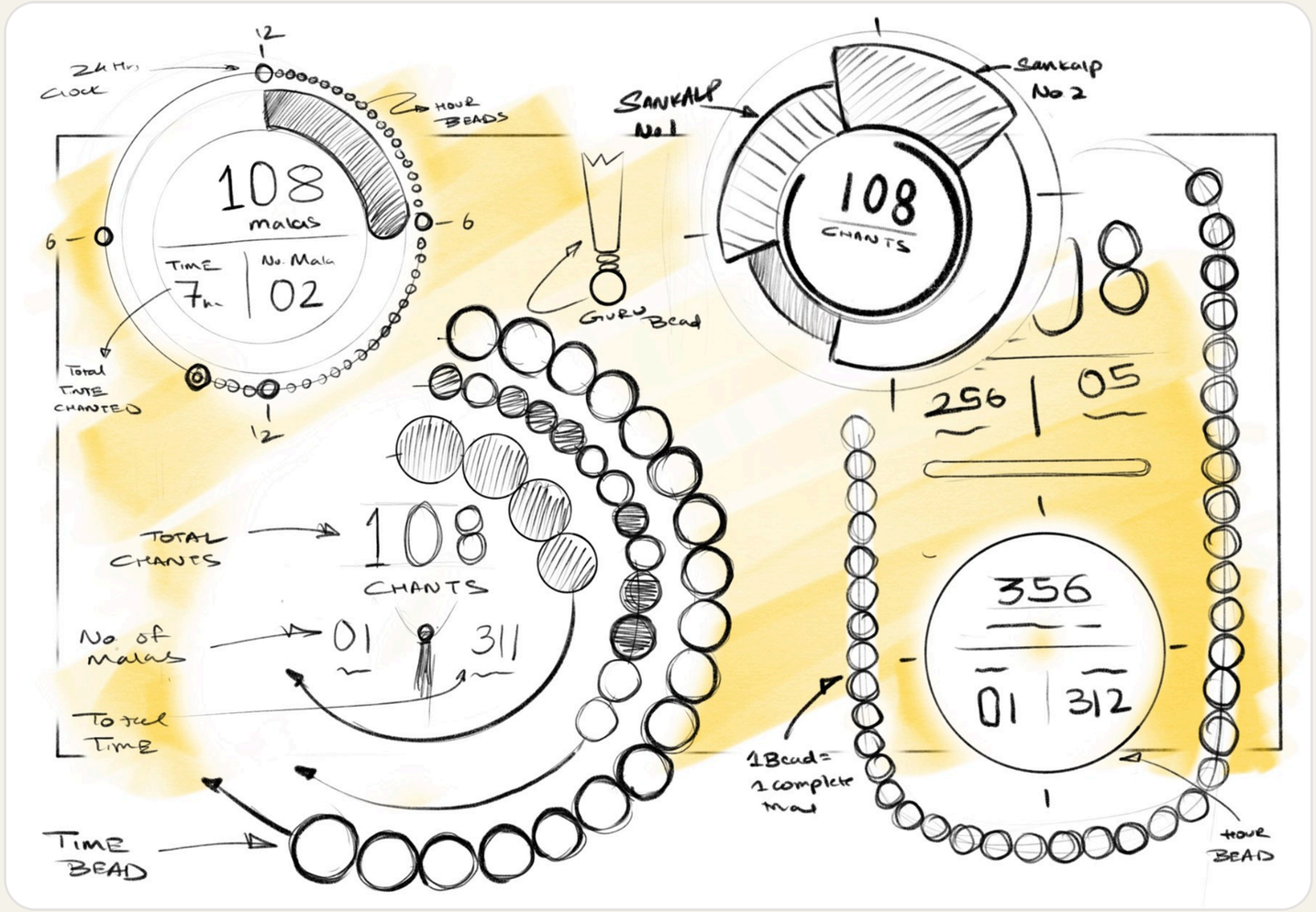
Sketching the practice meter

Before any screen, the data meter was explored on paper: how a mala, a day and a Sankalp could live in one shape.

MALA RING
108 beads around the edge, one bead for each completed mala.

24-HOUR CLOCK
hour beads with midnight at the top; each hour holds slices per Sankalp.

CENTRE
total chants, malas and time chanted, with the guru bead as the marker.



From a worn ring, to an app, to the mala people already hold

Stages, not parallel products.

1

Bead-based smart ring

Counting with a worn object.

2

App-only prototype

Counting and records on the phone.

3

LATEST

Attachment + phone option

Supports an existing mala; phone counting stays available.

The intent: support the practice object people already use. The choice is a design direction, not a result proved by research.

An existing mala with a removable module, and an app that organises intentions

PATH A · PROPOSED

Mala + removable module

Intended to detect each bead advance. Needs validation.

COMPANION APP

One record per Sankalp

Choose a Sankalp or Free chanting. Counts, malas, time and history are kept by intention.

PATH B · IN THE PROTOTYPE

Phone counting

Hold the screen. Volume buttons are a proposed addition.

Attachment position and fit

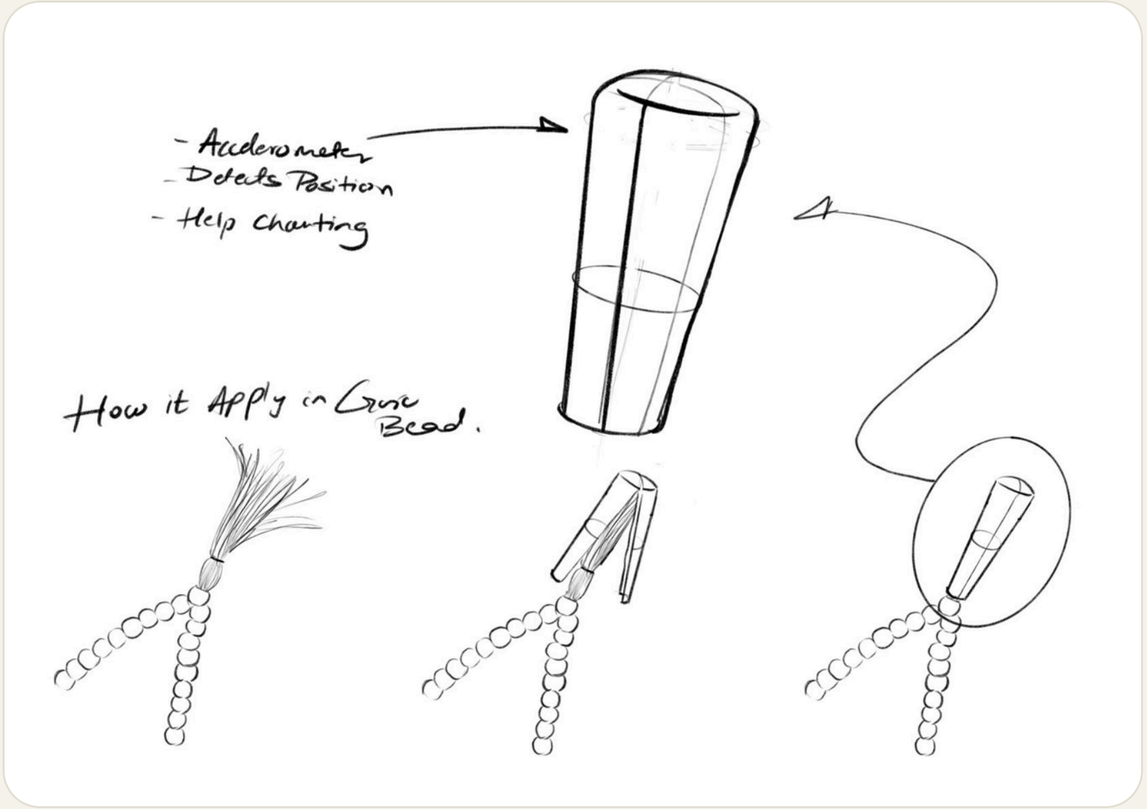
A firm connection between guru bead and tassel, with soft inserts for different malas.

MOUNT
near the guru-bead and tassel connection.

ACCESS
regular beads stay free to move by hand.

RETENTION
does not rely on loose tassel fibres.

FIT
replaceable soft inserts adapt the grip.

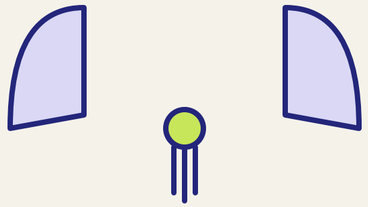


Original sketch: separate, opened around the tassel, and closed in place.

Snap-fit enclosure development

A split shell closes around the mala without cutting or tying it.

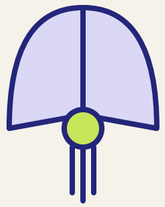
1



Open the two halves

Shell halves with a soft inner strip.

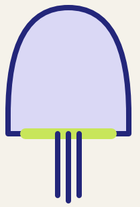
2



Place around the tassel and guru-bead region

Nothing is cut or tied.

3



Press together until the snap-fit closes

Regular beads stay free.

TO CHECK IN TESTING retention · easy removal · thread protection · balance · hand clearance.

OPEN hinge, latch geometry, dimensions, material.

Two counting paths that rejoin at the practice record

Physical flow, proposed.

1

Choose practice

A Sankalp or Free chanting

2

Counting method

Mala attachment or phone

3

Count

Attachment: start in app, subtle confirmation from the module. Phone: hold the screen.

4

Mala feedback

A cue when a mala completes

5

Finish and review

Saved to that practice’s record

The prototype shows phone counting. Pairing a mala is a mock flow; a real attachment connection is proposed.

Then the app grew up

The first prototype proved the idea. It still looked like a generic tracker. The redesign gives Sadhana a personality: calm, composed, spiritual but not religious.

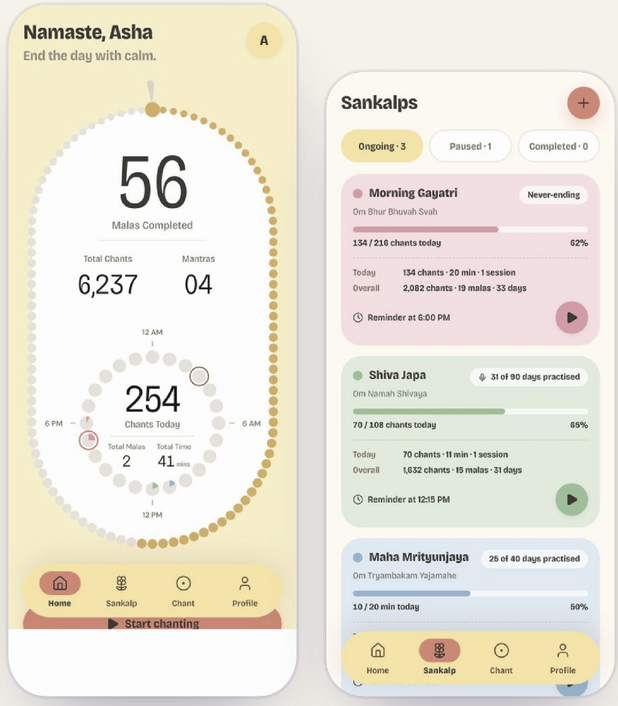
BEFORE

Butter, coral and brown. Rounded cards. Words that sounded like a checklist.

AFTER

Indigo and lime in light, plum and magenta in dark. Illustration-led onboarding. Warmer, more personal words.

BEFORE



AFTER



Two palettes, one calm voice

Light uses Neel. Dark uses Gulal. The chanting screen is always Gulal, so it stays easy on the eyes.

NEEL · LIGHT

Paper	Indigo	Lime	Mist	Coral
#F5F2EA	#23267A	#C8E65A	#DAD8F5	#E8795E

GULAL · DARK

Plum	Magenta	Turquoise	Marigold	Cream
#2B1A3A	#E4478B	#2EC4B6	#FFB627	#FBF6F0

S A D H A N A

Wordmark: light weight, wide tracking.

Bricolage Grotesque

Display. Headings and big numbers.

DM Sans

Body and interface text.

ओम नमः शिवाय

Tiro Devanagari Hindi. Mantras.

SIX SANKALP DYES

Each Sankalp keeps its own colour everywhere.

People, not mascots

Relatability comes from a person doing something familiar. Figures only, no scenery, each on a solid circle for depth.



Lost count



Hard to stay regular



Nothing to look back on



Well done



All set

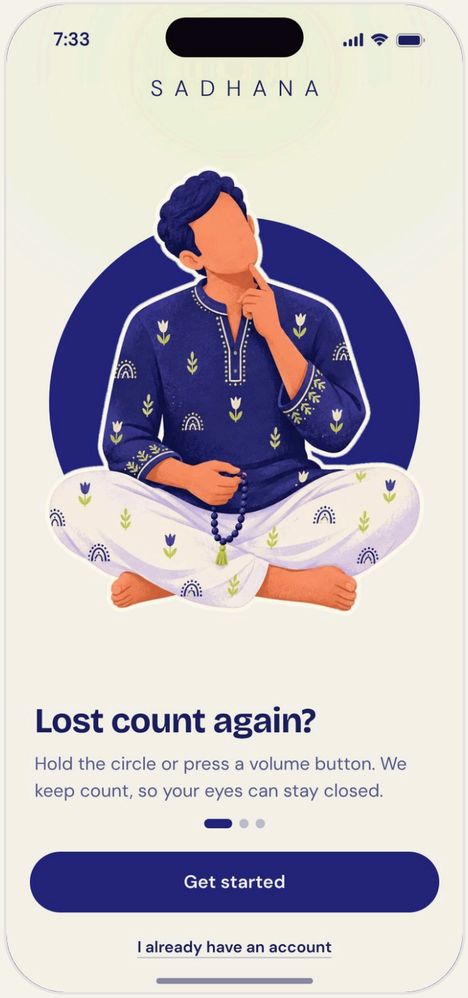
HUMANS ONLY
Faceless figures performing an action. No background.

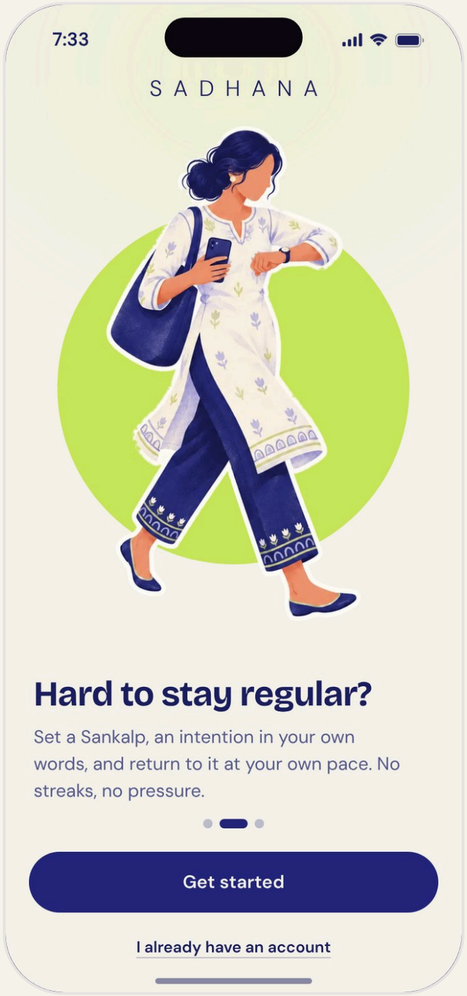
STICKER OUTLINE
Cream edge, soft grain, folk motifs on clothing.

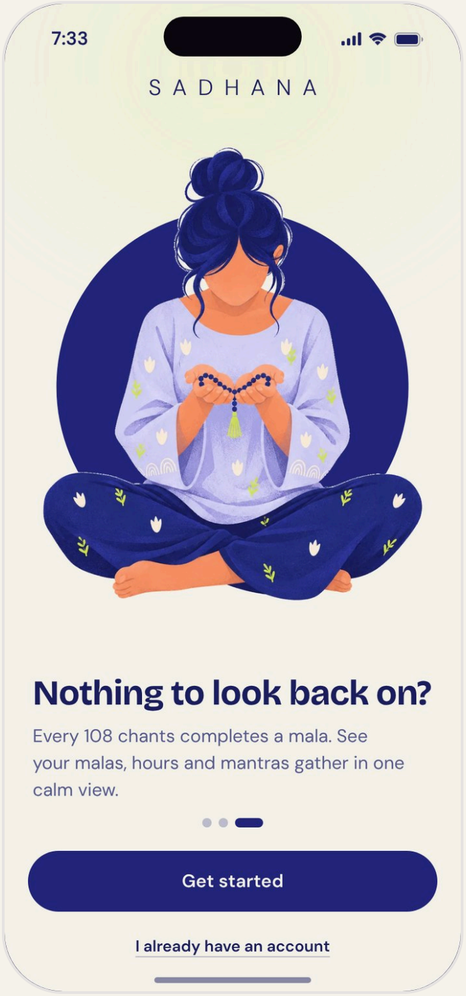
LIGHT AND DARK
Each figure has a recoloured dark twin.

Lead with the problem, not the feature

Each welcome slide names a moment people recognise, then shows how Sadhana helps.

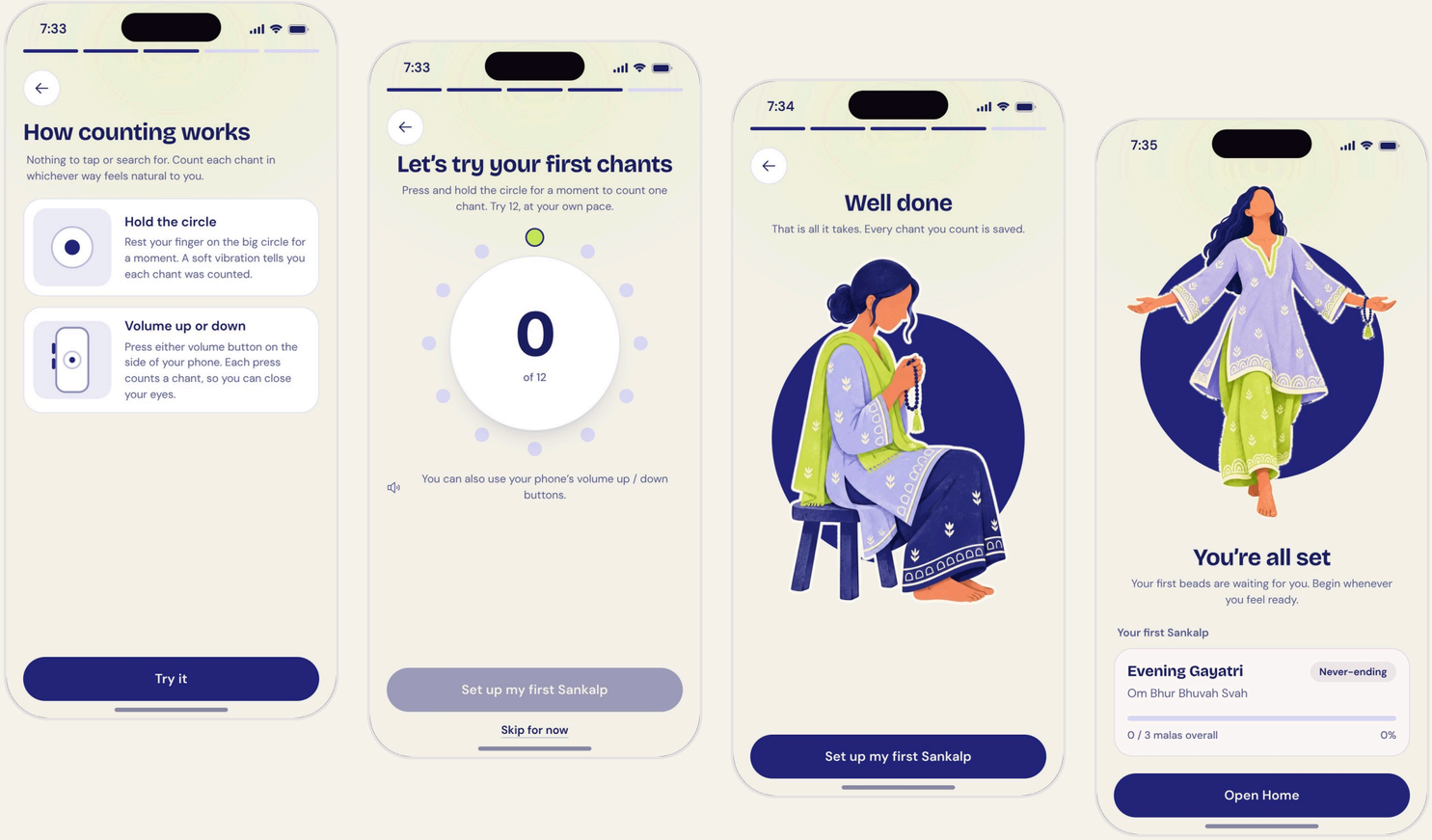






Learn by doing in under a minute

Show how counting works, let the person try twelve chants, then set up a first Sankalp.



Four short steps set up an intention

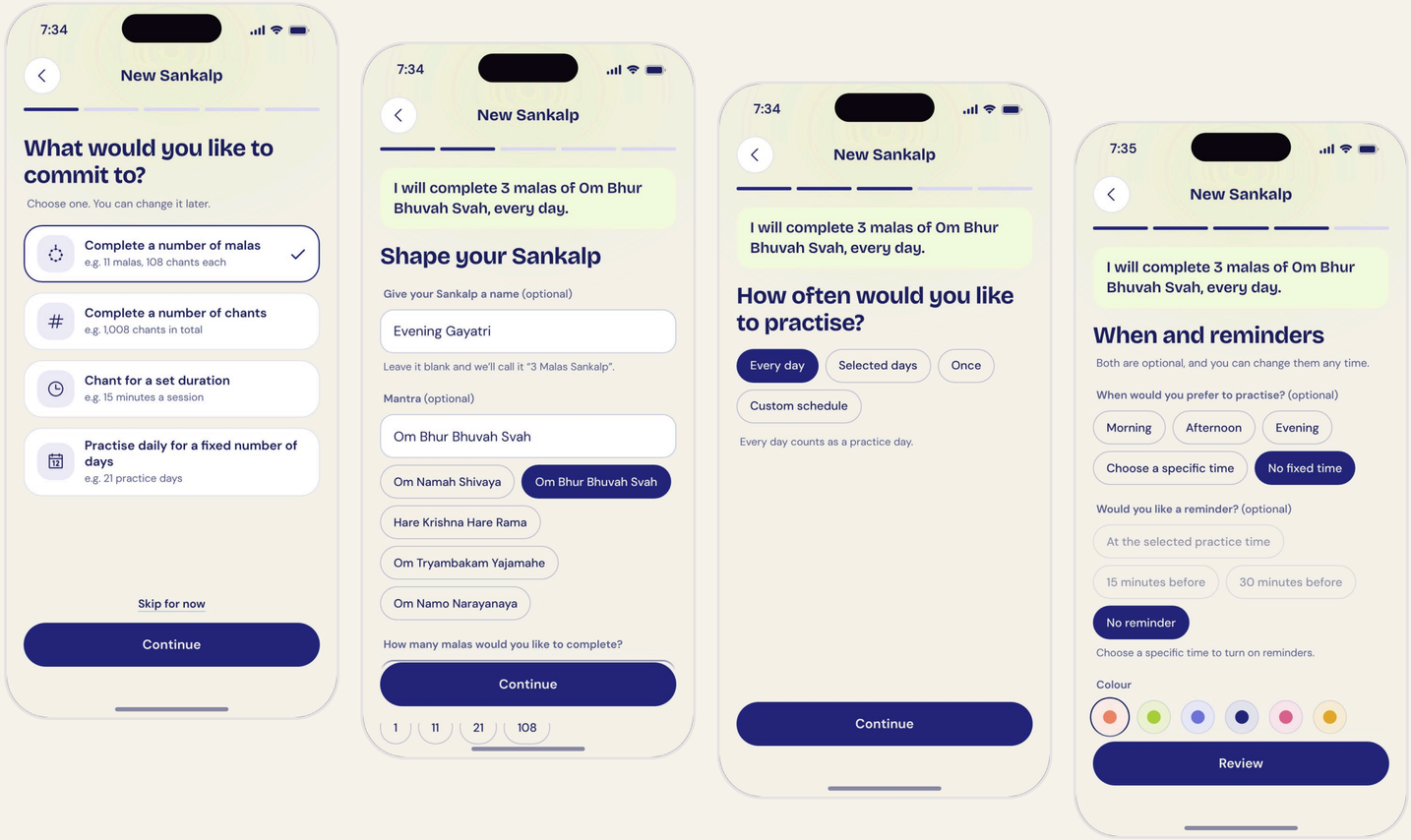
A live sentence at the top confirms what you are committing to.

WHAT
name, optional mantra, colour

HOW MUCH
chants or minutes, daily or total

HOW LONG
scheduled days, weekdays

ALSO
preferred time, reminder, recording



Choose the method, then keep the session quiet

The chanting screen is always dark and keeps controls out of the way.

PHONE
hold the circle for 300 ms to count one chant.

MALA
pairing is a mock flow. Automatic input is proposed.

CONTROL
pause and resume; hold 1.5 s to end.

Volume-button counting is proposed, not built.



Rules that keep records consistent

One mala is 108 chants, counted separately for each Sankalp.

SAME SANKALP

60 + 48 =

1 mala

Gayatri chants

DIFFERENT SANKALPS

60 Gayatri
48 Shiva =

0 malas

FREE CHANTING

Its own bucket

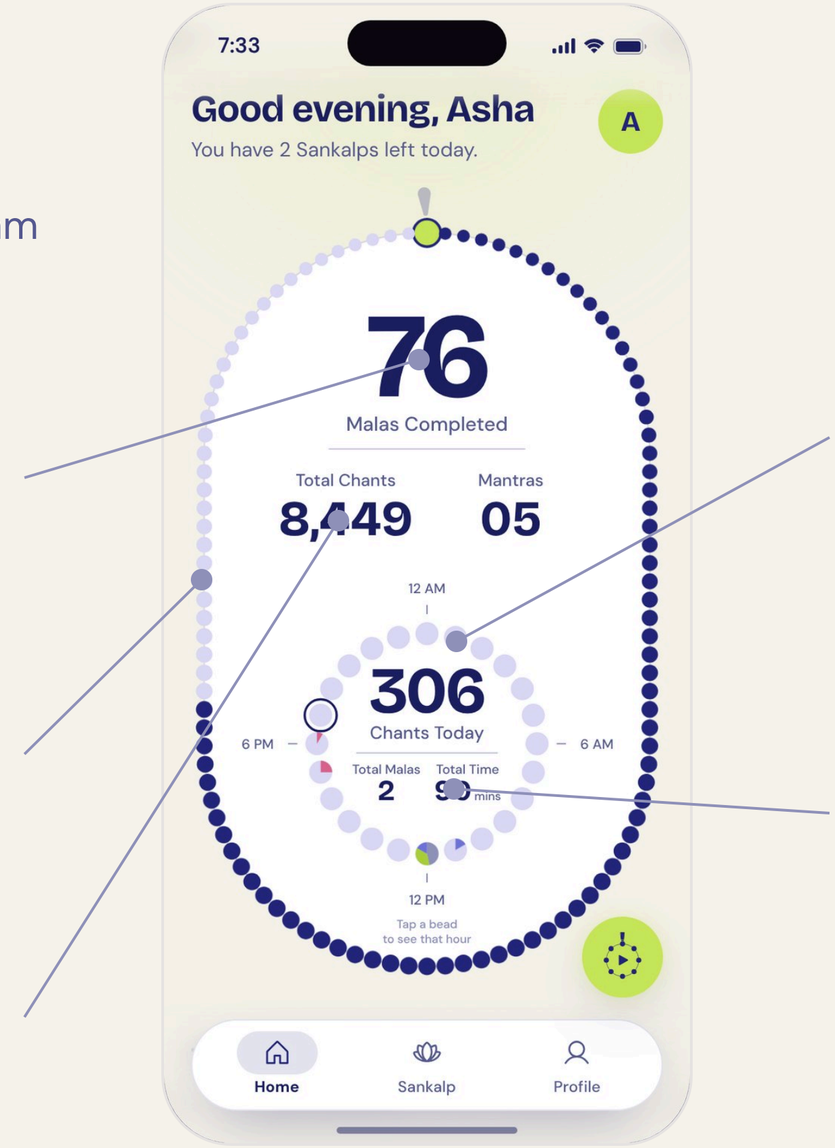
Never mixed with a Sankalp

TOTAL MALAS = sum of floor(chants ÷ 108) for each Sankalp, plus Free chanting.

SAVING a session with zero chants is discarded, even if the timer ran.

Reading the Home meter

Lifetime practice above, today's rhythm below. Numbers are sample data.



1 Malas completed

Every 108 chants make one mala. The large number shows the total malas completed.

2 Your mala ring

Each outer bead represents one completed mala. After all 108 beads are lit, a new ring begins.

3 Chants and mantras

Your total recorded chants and the number of different mantras you have practised.

4 Your day, hour by hour

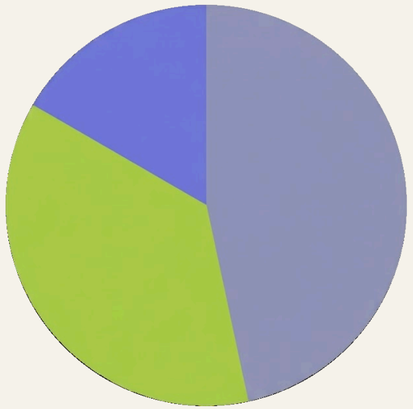
Each small bead represents one hour, with midnight at the top. Tap a bead to see the Sankalps practised in that hour.

5 Today at a glance

Today's chants, completed malas and active practice minutes sit inside the clock.

Inside one hour bead

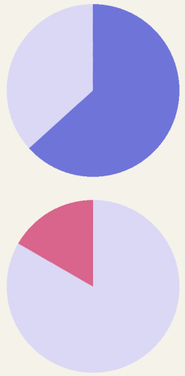
One bead can contain several Sankalps. Each coloured slice shows the time spent on that practice within the hour.



12–1 PM

Free chanting	**28 min**
Shiva Japa	**22 min**
Maha Mrityunjaya	**10 min**

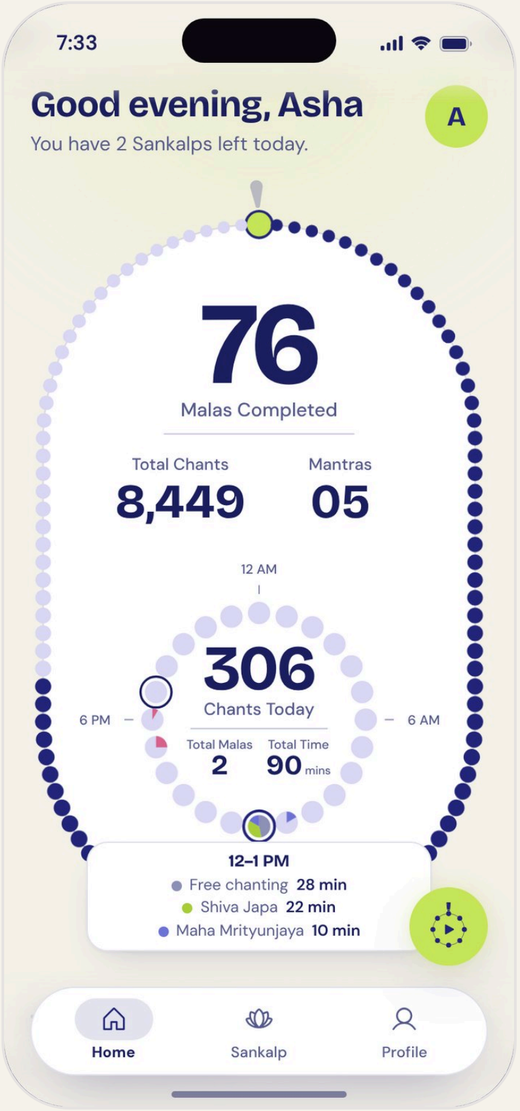
A BEAD WITH ONE SANKALP



Maha Mrityunjaya
40 min

Shree Ram mantra
10 min

A bead is full at 60 minutes. A Sankalp's slice is its minutes ÷ 60, and several Sankalps share one bead.



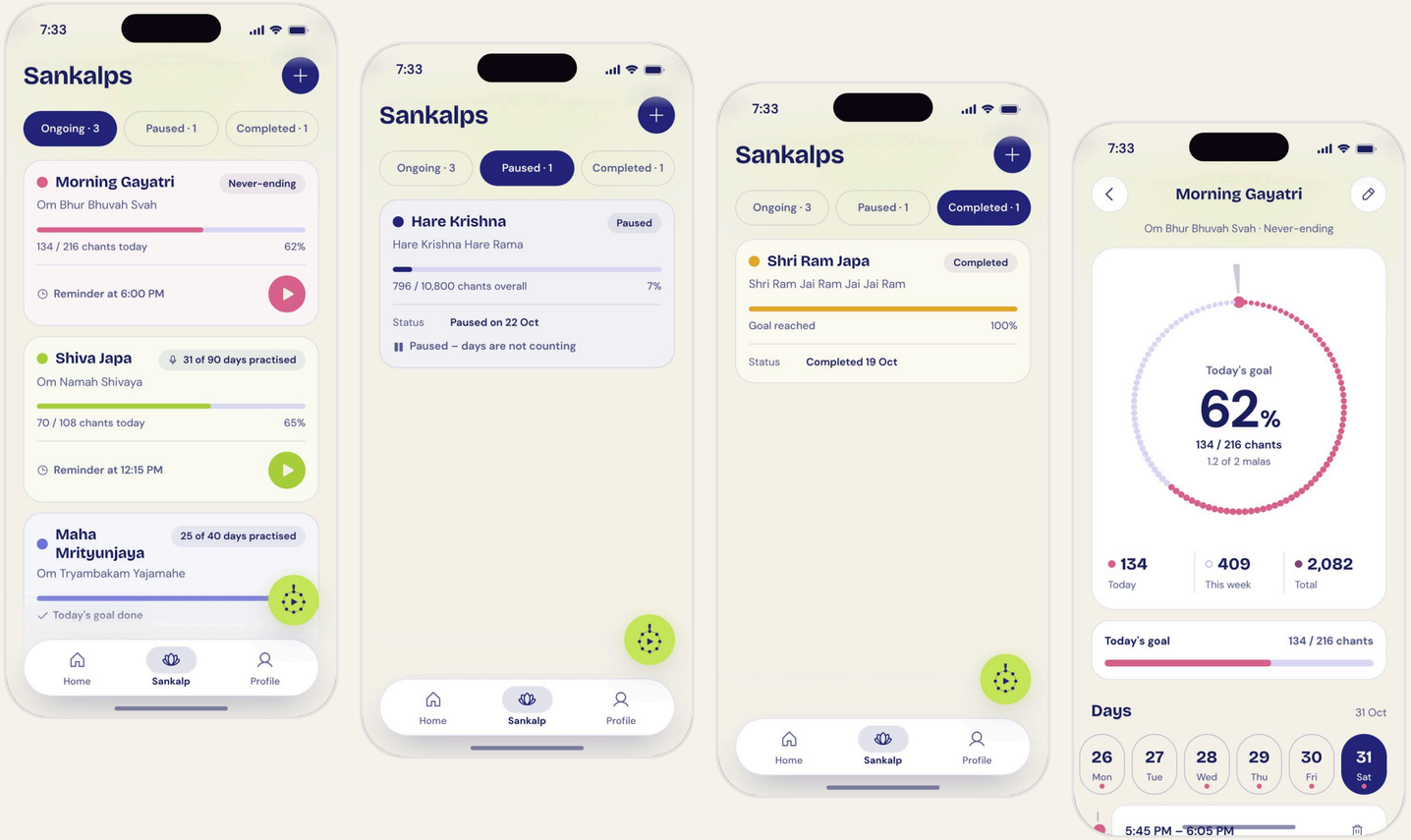
Every intention keeps its own story

Ongoing, paused and completed live in three tabs.

PROGRESS
daily or overall goal, days practised.

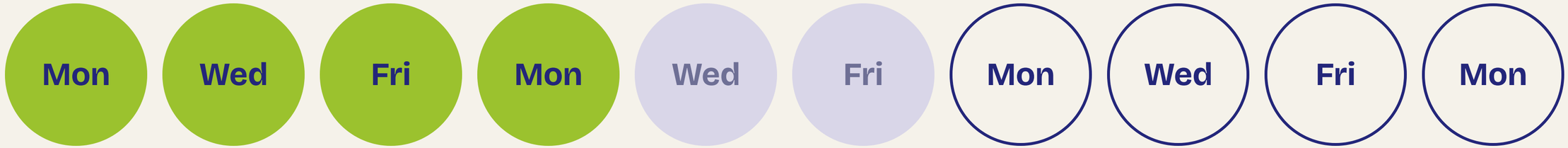
TIMELINE
each session's time, chants, malas and duration.

RECORDINGS
play buttons on sessions. Playback is simulated.



A limited Sankalp counts scheduled practice days, and completes only when you choose

Example: limited to 8 practice days, scheduled Mon, Wed, Fri.



Practised, counts · Paused, not counted · No chanting (open question) · Upcoming

PAUSE

Freezes the count. Resume continues it.

GOAL REACHED

The app asks “Mark as completed?”. You decide.

OPEN QUESTION

Does a scheduled day with no chanting use up a day? The prototype currently does not count it.

An interrupted session is kept, then resumed or finished

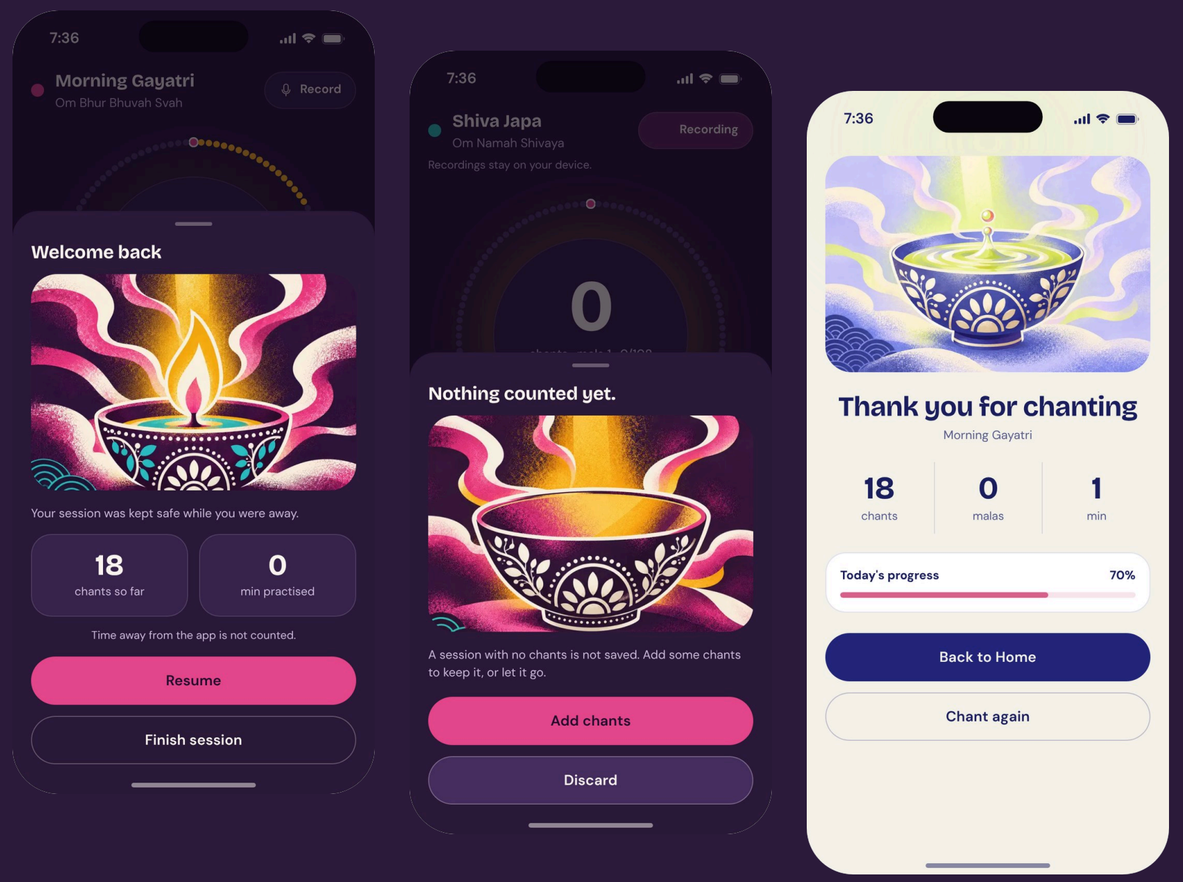
Counts and active time are saved. Time away is not counted.

WELCOME BACK
resume or finish.

NOTHING COUNTED
no chants, no saved session.

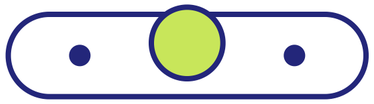
THANK YOU
a calm close that shows the mala progress.

Recording is simulated in the prototype. Audio capture, storage and interruption behaviour still need specifying.



Where does “Start chanting” live?

Reference apps with a record or start action usually centre it in the bar. We compared three placements.



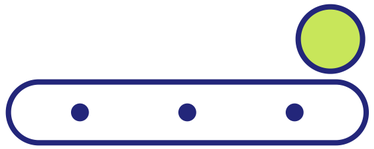
Centred in the bar

The common pattern. Crowds a three-tab bar and sits in the middle of every thumb path.



Left pill + separate button

A cleaner bar, but the button feels detached from the main action.



Floating above the bar

Like the add button in Google Drive. Always reachable, never in the way of the tabs.

CHOSEN

RESULT A three-tab pill (Home, Sankalp, Profile) with a round Chant button above it at the bottom right. Content blurs softly behind the bar and the status area as it scrolls.

Calm in every detail

Light and dark, warm words, a soft bead sound and gentle motion.

TONE
warmer and more personal on every screen. No exclamation marks, no emoji, no streaks or points.

SOUND
a soft bead click, off by default.

MOTION
made in code; respects reduced motion.

~~Goal completed!~~ **Thank you for chanting**

~~No data yet~~ **Your first beads are waiting for you**

~~Session interrupted~~ **Welcome back**



Open questions

What the prototype does not yet answer.

1
Does an unpractised scheduled day count?

The prototype does not count it. Needs a decision with practitioners.

2
How should the outer beads fill?

Each bead is one mala today. The mapping is still open.

3
Which hour-bead encoding reads best?

Colour ratio is confirmed. Size and fill are not.

4
Can an attachment sense bead advances reliably?

Unproven. Needs a physical prototype and testing on different malas.

5
How should recording work?

Capture, storage and interruption behaviour still need specifying.

6
Does it hold up with real practitioners?

The persona is an assumption. Next: short sessions on a phone.

Open the Sadhana prototype

A single-file HTML prototype. Best opened on a phone, or in a desktop browser where it shows inside a phone frame.

WORKS

counting by holding the circle, separate Sankalps, hourly pies, interrupted-session recovery, light and dark.

SIMULATED

mala pairing, recording and reminders.

S A D H A N A

